

LEDGER · 2026-08-28 · BIOTECHNOLOGY

Recombinant Ice-Binding Proteins (IBPs) via Methylotrophic Yeast Fermentation

REJECTED

This concept did **not** clear the framework.
The reasoning is published in full below.
What the assessment found

Incumbent benchmark	CryoStor® CS10 (BioLife Solutions)
Entry application	cGMP biopreservation of primary mammalian cells (PBMCs, T-Cells, MSCs) in cell therapies
Measured advantage	Post-thaw viability increases of +10% to +28% across mammalian cell lines compared to 10% DMSO baseline
Time to first revenue	24 months
Gross margin at parity	47.8%
Startup CapEx	\$45,000
Payback from first sale	52.3 months
Capital productivity	1.6x

Regulatory risk

Moderate — qualification costs reported (\$830,000 estimated)

Why it failed

- Voided by: Capital and time to revenue, Economics undisclosed, Negative control / sub-2x
- Margin fails the operating-cost check

Assessment

The concept explicitly discloses a startup CapEx of \$830,000 (exceeding the \$250,000 limit) and a 24-30 month timeline to first commercial delivery. Additionally, the viability gains of +10% to +28% fall short of the required 2x performance step-change bar.

Also flagged

- Price parity asserted, not sourced

A rejection is not a claim that the science is wrong. It means the venture case did not survive: the comparator was not what the buyer actually buys, the comparison was not like-for-like, the advantage fell short of a step change, or the capital and time to first revenue were prohibitive.

Assessed 2026-08-28 against seven gates plus the voiding sub-tests. [How the method works](#) · [Browse all concepts](#)

The Absence Audit

Method

Ledger

Free studies

Track record

Terms

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